▶ AHMEDABAD AIR TRAGEDY

FATAL TRAJECTORY

Four possible reasons why the Boeing Dreamliner came down in a crash a few seconds after takeoff

Graphic by **NILANJAN DAS**/*Text by* **AVISHEK G. DASTIDAR**

1. ENGINE FAILURE AND FUEL STARVATION

- Engine or propulsion system failure is a plausible line. It's buttressed by videos that show the plane didn't gain altitude after it took off
- An unexpected loss of thrust in one/both engines caused by a mechanical failure, flameout or fuel starvation—where the engines do not get sufficient fuel—might have left the crew with little time to take control





2. BIRD HITS

Bird activity is not unusual in the vicinity of the Ahmedabad airport, especially in the mornings. But the winged creatures would have had to be ingested by both engines in the critical moments after takeoff for them to stall together

TOP SPEED ACHIEVED
174 KNOTS (322 KMPH), before the plane begins to fall

CRASH
30 SECONDS after takeoff

241

DEATH TOLL

People killed on board, with one survivor. As yet unknown number of casualties on the ground as plane ploughs into medical college hostel